

| By Subhash Mishra |

Hell hath no fury like Mayawati defeated. After the Lok Sabha election results exposed the fragility of the social engineering experiment that won the Bahujan Samaj Party (BSP) an absolute majority in the Uttar Pradesh Assembly elections two years ago, Mayawati is on the rampage, much like an elephant, her party symbol.

In less than a week, she has dismissed party functionaries privileged enough to have had red beacons atop their vehicles, sacked several party leaders, including Brahmins, transferred nearly 50 IAS and IPS officers and issued a diktat that would allow only Dalits to occupy key positions in the party organisation. She has even suspended Ajay Mishra, a Brahmin IPS officer, on what most believe are flimsy grounds. Urban Development Minister Nakul Dubey was removed from the post of chairman of the Jal Nigam, a humiliation that left the minister fuming. Sensing this, the BSP then clarified that the minister had volunteered to be removed.

The resurgence of the Congress in the state has set the alarm bells ringing for the BSP leader, who has swung into action to prevent any return of Dalits back into the fold of the Congress. She has disbanded all "bhaichara committees" of Brahmins, Rajputs and Vaishyas that were set up in all 403 Assembly constituencies to integrate the upper castes with the Scheduled Castes. Mayawati has also taken away the rights of ministers on transfers, postings and suspensions; removed district magistrates and superintendents of police in most of the constituencies where BSP candidates lost; has got red beacons removed from the cars of nearly 150 party functionaries, most of whom were enjoying the status of minister of state as chairpersons, vice-chairpersons or members of a state-run corporation or commission.

Interestingly, the Uttar Pradesh chief minister is not bothered about her arch rival Mulayam Singh Yadav's Samajwadi Party (SP). She spared

Rout and RETRIBUTION

A poll-stung Mayawati takes the party and officialdom to task and moves to consolidate her Dalit votebank

PHOTOGRAPHS by Sanjay Sonkar



MAYAWATI WITH BSP LEADER SATISH MISHRA; (RIGHT) THE CONFERENCE OF IAS AND IPS OFFICERS IN LUCKNOW

Etawah and Ferozabad, from where SP chief Mulayam and his son Akhilesh won the Lok Sabha elections respectively. On the contrary, officers in the constituencies—Rae Bareilly, Sultanpur, Unnao, Gonda, Bahraich and Kheri—where the Congress won by defeating the BSP, were removed at the first stroke. The reason lies in the division of what she sees as primarily her votebank, the Scheduled Castes.

The SP, though, banks heavily on Yadavs and Muslims. It is another matter that the Congress may have made inroads here too.

An infuriated Mayawati, however, did not stop at that. She recently called a meeting of her ministers along with their principal secretaries and secretaries and told them, "I am well aware of the corruption, commission culture, blackmailing and